BRANDON SANTOR

GEOSPATIAL RESEARCH | SCIENTIFIC SOFTWARE | U.S. MARINE CORPS VETERAN

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Geospatial researcher and software developer building scientific tools from data preparation through the interface. My work spans tree-growth and climate analysis, hydrothermal-vent mapping, reconstructed Martian terrain, spatial evidence systems, and independent research on smartphone satellite positioning. I study geographic information science and technology at Texas A&M and served in the U.S. Marine Corps.

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant & Software Developer | Torbenson Lab

March 2026-present | Paid appointment since June 2026

- Independently built the Tree-Ring Atlas Explorer (TRAE) in response to lab needs; its research use led to a paid appointment for continued software development and research support.
- Added reviewed data imports, linked maps and graphs, climate matching, saved work sessions, and exports that record source and method details. Built tools for PRISM gridded climate data, NetCDF multidimensional files, ROXAS wood-anatomy outputs, and year-labeled WalDendro X-ray records.
- Used TRAE to derive summaries, organize study data, and prepare exports for a co-authored manuscript in preparation; its screening summaries support analysis but do not replace scientific validation.

Research Lead & GIS Developer | New World Screwworm (NWSW)

Fall 2026-present | Texas A&M GIS Practicum

- Lead New World Screwworm research coordination and GIS delivery: reconcile sources, integrate the team's evidence, and build a scripted ArcGIS workflow with checks for identifiers, geometry, attributes, and coordinate systems.
- Used Research Architect to generate the project's coordination system, then developed recoverable research-context paging, versioned assignments, and SHA-256 file checks for traceable handoffs.
- Independently built a separate spatial evidence application: FastAPI serves the browser interface, PostGIS links records to geographic features, and TypeScript and Leaflet support mapped review.

Independent Esri GIS Technical Consultant & Instructor

February-May 2026

- Audited seven graduate GIS modules and rebuilt six workflows into 189 pages of illustrated technical manuals.
- Corrected GIS software and projection problems, misaligned map grids, database structure and geographic-join errors, licensing issues, and desktop-to-web failures.
- Built quality-control checkpoints and taught reproducible workflows that enabled the client to execute corrected analyses independently.

High School Baseball Coach

2013-2020 | Paid program coach

- Coached nearly 100 student-athletes each year, developing baseball skills, teamwork, and discipline.
- Coordinated conditioning, equipment, and maintenance for the program.
- Mentored student-athletes and emphasized education throughout their high school experience.

U.S. Marine Corps | Infantryman, Acting Platoon Sergeant & Logistics NCO

2011-2013

- Managed logistical support, inventory, and resource allocation for a company-sized element of approximately 350 Marines.
- Coordinated personnel and mission-critical field operations under strict safety, accountability, and risk-management requirements.
- Applied disciplined decision-making, communication, and logistical problem-solving in high-pressure field environments.

TEKsystems | Network & Computer Systems Contractor

2007-2011

- Executed enterprise hardware and software deployments involving 100+ devices per project during nationwide infrastructure upgrades.
- Independently diagnosed complex computer and network systems issues across changing client environments.
- Installed, configured, and supported systems while coordinating with local and remote technical teams.

SELECTED SOFTWARE & RESEARCH

Mars Explorer

Team lead | Database & 3D systems

- Lead a five-person team. Built a spatial database with 41 connected tables for rover locations, science observations, and source files; also developed data pipelines, a read-only data service, and a Cesium terrain system that turns orbital elevation and imagery into bounded 3D terrain.

Thermal Vent Atlas Explorer

Independent creator & developer

- Built and delivered an online/offline research atlas to Sylvan Lab for review and internal use. It maps 742 vent records against seafloor depth and tectonic boundaries, while keeping researcher-added microbial context separate from the source records.

COLE | Cost Of Living Explorer

Project lead | Feature integration

- Lead COLE design and feature integration across household budgets, climate, hazards, industry employment, and Census poverty/education estimates. Delivered a tested v0.7.0 Windows preview with source-aware filters, read-only feature databases, and comparisons of up to three counties.

Research Architect (RA)

Creator & principal designer | PhalAInx independent software studio

- Created a framework that configures an AI assistant kit for each member of a human research team and connects their work through shared methods, context, review, and handoffs.

High Command (HC)

Creator & developer | PhalAInx independent software studio

- Built a Windows alpha with Tauri 2, React/TypeScript, Rust, and SQLite: saved briefs, imported AI transcripts, manual tasks and milestones, and fingerprint-verified workspace backups.

The Deception Gap | Smartphone GNSS

Independent continued research

- Expanded a class project into independent satellite-positioning research, more than doubling the original collection to 781 retained readings from three smartphones across five crowd categories; led continued field collection, statistical analysis, interpretation, and poster development.

NASA SUITS Challenge Proposal

Team lead & primary system designer | 2021-2022

- Led conceptual HoloLens 2 mixed-reality interface design for extravehicular activity (EVA), with local positioning, navigation, terrain/hazard overlays, and geological annotation; co-authored technical documentation submitted to NASA for review.

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University

Expected May 2027 | B.S. in Geographic Information Science & Technology | Institutional GPA: 4.0 / 4.0

A.S. Computer Networking

ITT Technical Institute | 2007

HONORS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Second Place | TxGIS Day Undergraduate Student Research Presentation Competition | 2025 | Health Geography GIS and statistical analysis

Galloway '29 Aggie Veteran Freedom Scholarship II | Two-time recipient | 2025-2027

Dennis W. Hughes '79 & Melinda Hood Hughes '81 Endowed Scholarship in Geography | Two-time recipient | 2025-2027

Richard A. & Mollie B. Williford Dean's Scholarship | College of Arts & Sciences | 2026-2027

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Languages: Python; JavaScript / TypeScript; HTML / CSS; Rust.

Geospatial tools: ArcGIS Pro / Field Maps; QGIS / GDAL; PostgreSQL / PostGIS; Cesium / Leaflet; Rasterio.

Application development: FastAPI / Flask; React / Vite / Tauri 2; SQLite; PyInstaller / Windows packaging; JSON Schema.

Research methods & data: NumPy / pandas; Scientific import / export; Smartphone satellite-positioning field analysis; Research source tracking; SHA-256 manifests.

RESEARCH COMMUNICATION

Co-authored manuscript in preparation with Torbenson Lab; scientific workflow development and research presentation.